

Acer on India's gaming ecosystem

There's still plenty of room to grow, says Acer APAC President, **Andrew Hou**

Divyanshi Sharma | editor@digit.in

For the longest time, gaming in India lived in the shadows of what were considered "real careers." That narrative, however, has shifted decisively over the past few years. Competitive gaming and esports are no longer niche interests reserved for a small set of people. They are organised, aspirational, and increasingly mainstream.

Around two months back in November 2025, Krafton brought the Battlegrounds Mobile India International Cup to India in New Delhi. And recently, Acer hosted the Predator League 2026 Asia Pacific Finale in the capital as well on January 10 and January 11, marking one of the most significant moments for India's place in the global esports ecosystem.

On the sidelines of the tournament, we sat down with Andrew Hou, President of Pan-Asia Pacific Operations at Acer Group, and Harish Kohli, President and Managing Director at Acer India. The conversation revolved around India's gaming landscape, Acer's long-term commitment to the market, and what the future holds for gamers. Here are excerpts from the conversation.

India's gaming ecosystem has moved from casual play to organised esports rather quickly. What has surprised you the most about this evolution compared to other APAC markets?

Andrew: India has a huge population and a young generation. When we talk about esports, it is similar to other South Asian countries like the Philippines and Thailand, which also have young generations and young people like to play games. In that sense, India is similar to other countries.

However, one thing that is different is that around six or seven years ago, I spoke to Harish about selling Predator gaming devices in India since Acer has the Predator brand. The feedback from the team was that most parents in India

wanted their kids to focus on studies instead of playing games. At that time, the ecosystem was not ready. The general perception among parents was that playing games would affect their children's studies.



Andrew Hou
President of Pan-Asia
Pacific Operations at
Acer Group

Over the past several years, the environment has changed. The gaming ecosystem has become mature, and kids can now study gaming and even become professionals. It has become a different route for kids as well.

So today, I would say that gaming and esports in India have become more mature, but there is still a lot of room to grow.

The penetration is not very high yet, but the potential for Acer is very strong.

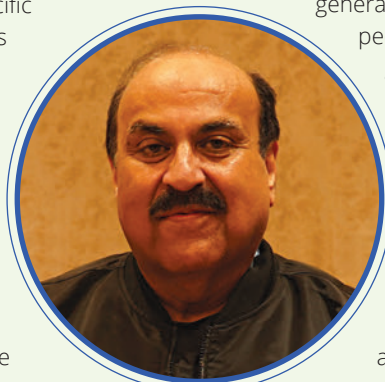
Is Acer planning any other long term investments here in India with respect to gaming and esports?

Harish: ACD is an investment we make on a yearly basis at the Asia Pacific level, and we will continue to do that. We have main-

tained these investments year on year because we have seen their impact on market share and overall growth. As we move forward, there may be one or two additions that we look at introducing in the country. At the Asia Pacific level, we will also continue to evaluate further opportunities.

Laptop gaming remains huge in the APAC region. How does Acer balance portability, thermals, and performance as games become more demanding?

Andrew: That is true. This is why we have our AeroBlade technology, which is in its fifth generation. It allows us to use thinner fans while delivering better performance in Predator laptops. This helps dissipate more heat compared to other brands. We also use over 20 fan blade pairs, which significantly improves thermal performance. **d**



Harish Kohli
President and Managing
Director at Acer India

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